

**Board 2**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A Q 10  
♥ J 6 2  
♦ Q J 10 8  
♣ 9 6 4

♠ J 7 5 2  
♥ A K 9 8 5  
♦ 7 3  
♣ 8 3



♠ K 6 4  
♥ Q 10 4  
♦ 9 6 5  
♣ 10 7 5 2

♠ 9 8 3  
♥ 7 3  
♦ A K 4 2  
♣ A K Q J

| West     | North | East | South |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
|          |       |      | 1NT   |
| Pass     | 2♣    | Pass | 2♦    |
| Pass     | 2♥    | Pass | 3NT   |
| All Pass |       |      |       |

3NT by South  
has is the ♥ A K.

In response to partner's Stayman bid you bid 2♦ to indicate no 4-card Major. Partner now bids 2♥.

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Partner's bid shows 5♥s, and by inference, 4♠s. Your hand does not provide an 8-card fit in either Major, so with 17 points you say 3NT.

South plays 3NT. West leads the ♦ Q.

Winner List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 2 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 4 :: Total = 8

You need one more winner and without question it must come from the ♥ suit.

Your problem is finding dummy entries, all dummy

You must find the ♥s split 3-3. You must also duck a ♥ to keep a valuable entry. Win the ♦ and play the ♥7, ducking in dummy.

East will win the ♥ and return a ♦ which you win in your hand. You now play your last ♥ to dummy, and if the suit was originally 3-3 you will win 4 ♥ tricks.

The "brute force" method for establishing dummy's ♥ suit would be to play ♥ A K, then another. If they split 3-3 your last two ♥s would be winners.

Of course you'd look pretty stupid to have those 2 ♥ winners in dummy and no way to reach them.

So you use the duck instead.

**Board 4**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A Q 4  
 ♥ Q J 10 3  
 ♦ 10 7 2  
 ♣ 10 6 5

♠ J 9 8 7 5 2

♥ 6 5 2

♦ K

♣ 9 7 4



♠ 6 3

♥ 9 8 4

♦ A 8 6 4 3

♣ Q J 3

♠ K 10

♥ A K 7

♦ Q J 9 5

♣ A K 8 2

With your 6-card Major suit you naturally use a transfer; bid 3♥. Partner responds 3♠.

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Partner has at least 20 points so you bid 4♠.

The contract would be 4♠ played by North.

South plays 4♠. West leads the ♥Q and East plays ♥4.

| West     | North | East | South |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
|          |       |      | 2NT   |
| Pass     | 3♥    | Pass | 3♠    |
| Pass     | 4♠    |      |       |
| All Pass |       |      |       |

4♠ by South

Loser List: ♠ = 2 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 5

You win the first trick with your ♥A. By doing this you leave West in the dark about who holds the ♥K. If you had instead won with the ♥K West would have known you held both honors since East would have played the ♥A if he held it.

You have 2 losers to get rid of and the good news is that you can establish 2 ♦ winners pretty easily. So do you start pulling trumps now?

No, stay away from trumps for now. You might have to lose the lead twice in trumps, and the first time they get the lead they will play another ♥ and expose the loser in that suit. Then, the next time they get the lead they will take their ♥ winner. You need to get rid of that ♥ loser **BEFORE** you start on trumps.

Play a small ♦ to the ♦K. East will take this and play another ♥ to your ♥K. Play your ♦Q and discard dummy's ♥ loser. Now you might just as well ruff that ♥ in dummy, (with the ♠7 to be safe), and play trumps from that side. It turns out that West has both high trumps but you don't care because dummy's ♣ loser can be dumped on your ♦J.

The ♦A was a "fast" loser which you couldn't avoid. But the ♥ loser was a "slow" loser. Slow losers can sometimes be discarded, but you may have to do so before you lose the lead too many times.

Did you notice that if the opening lead had been a ♣ instead of a ♥ you would have used the same technique?